

NO KINGS

A card game about toppling monarchy · 2–6 players · first to 50 points wins (or 20 for a Short Game)

The realm of **Cardlandia** is fracturing. The Crown hoards wealth while the streets boil with unrest — yet absolute power is an intoxicating poison. Topple the old regime, claim the glory, and gather **50 points** to found a new order. But beware: if tyranny secures a stronghold before the revolution succeeds, the old world wins. Short on time? Play a **Short Game** — first to **20** instead.

THE CAST & THE DECK

A standard 52-card deck with the court renamed, plus 4 wild Jokers.

CARD	WHO THEY ARE
Kings (K)	Absolute Monarchs. Tyrants never hide — the instant you draw a King you must play it face-up in front of you.
Queens (Q)	Cunning Plotters , scheming from the shadow of your hand.
Generals (10)	The Military Brass — loyal to command, coup, or chaos.
Bishops (A)	The Holy Order , wielding religious sanction against the Crown.
The Crowd (2–9)	The Common Folk. Weak alone, devastating when united.
Jacks (J)	Ambitious Heirs in the wings. Jacks can never be discarded — they wait until the throne is vacant.

Players — default **4** (Hearts, Diamonds, Clubs, Spades). For **5–6 players** the working guilds join with one full extra suit each: the 5th is **Anvils** (green), the 6th is **Wheat** (blue).

THE REVOLUTIONARY CYCLE

1. The **oldest player** takes the first turn; play proceeds **clockwise**.
2. **Draft support** — draw one card. Draw a **King** and you crown yourself at once, face-up on the table. Otherwise keep it in hand.
3. **Maintain order** — hand limit 7. Discard the excess out of play, but ambitious **Jacks refuse to be discarded**.
4. **Strike or plot** — launch a strike to topple standing Kings, or hold your cards for a larger coup.

THE THREE REVOLUTIONARY PATHS

Every takedown is one of three easy ideas. A toppled King becomes a **Fallen King** in your victory pile; the cards used are discarded.

PATH	THE MOVE	EFFECT
Palace Coup faces & 10s	Any pair of high cards — two of Queen / Jack / General (Q+General, Q+Jack, two Generals, Jack+General...)	topple 1 King
	Royal bloodline — a same-suit Queen + General	topple ALL of one player's Kings
Holy Decree Bishops / Aces	1 Bishop of the King's own suit — or — 2 Bishops of any suit	topple 1 King
The Mob numbers 2–9	Riot — three of a kind (three 2–9 of one rank)	topple 1 King
	Revolt — a same-suit run of 2–9, 4 / 5 / 6+ long	topple 1 / 2 / 3 Kings

Any alliance of two ruling-class cards topples a King; the only exception is a matching bloodline, which wipes a whole court. Bishops handle the church's business. The Mob follows standard card logic — sets and runs.

Revolt is a run of **consecutive same-suit number cards 2–9** — never a face card inside the run — all aimed at **one player's** Kings. A Bishop may lead the march for flavor, but adds no count.

THE SECOND WAVE — Jack's ambition

- When **every true King** has fallen, the ambitious **Jacks instantly rise as Promoted Kings** — everyone reveals their Jacks at once.
- A single **General** can crush a Promoted King (discarded).
- **Joker + General** is a swift assassination: remove a Promoted King and claim the Jack as a **Promoted Fallen King**.
- **Bishops, Palace-Coup pairs, and Revolts** topple Promoted Kings by their normal rules.

THE GRAND RECKONING — scoring

FEAT / PENALTY	POINTS
Fallen King in your victory pile	+2
Promoted Fallen King (a lesser monarch)	+1
Surviving Queen in hand at scoring	+1
4 Kings standing in front of you (or a coup)	+10
Each King / Promoted King left on the table	–1 all
Caught holding a King at scoring	round = 0

Generals' coup: hold **all 4 Generals** when the **4th King** is played and you may claim the **+10** instead of whoever raised the Kings.

ENDING A ROUND

A round ends when **either** a player has **4 Kings standing** (a tyrannical dynasty is secured — *a loss for society, a win for the individual*), **or** the **draw deck is played through once**. Tally scores, reshuffle, next round. **First**

to 50 points wins — or agree on a **Short Game to 20** before you deal. The "four" thresholds stay at four even in 5–6 player games.

QUICK REFERENCE

1. **Palace Coup** — any **2 high cards** (Q / J / General) = topple **1 King**. *Same-suit Queen + General wipes ALL.*
2. **Holy Decree** — **1 matching Bishop** OR **2 Bishops** = topple **1 King**.
3. **The Mob** — **3-of-a-kind** OR a same-suit **run of 4+** = topple **1 / 2 / 3 Kings**.
4. **Scoring** — Kings = **2**, Promoted Jacks / Queens = **1**, four Kings (or coup) = **10**. Hold a King → round = **0**.
First to 50 wins (Short Game: 20).